

All creatures worship God most high

Alt. title: All creatures of our God and King

Text: Saint Francis of Assisi, 1225;
tr. William H. Draper, 1926; alt.
LASST UNS ERFREUEN LM

Music: Geistliche Kirchengesang, 1623

arr. Ralph Vaughan Williams, 1906

The musical score is written for a two-part setting (Soprano and Bass) in 3/2 time, with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a steady rhythm. The accompaniment consists of block chords in the bass line. The lyrics are arranged in two columns, with the first column starting on the first line of music and the second column starting on the second line. The score is divided into four systems, each with a key signature change indicated by a sharp sign on the F line of the treble clef staff. The first system has a key signature of one sharp (F#). The second system has a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The third system has a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, and G#). The fourth system has a key signature of four sharps (F#, C#, G#, and D#). The lyrics are as follows:

1 *All crea-tures, wor-ship God most high, lift up your voice in earth and sky,
2 Thou rush-ing wind that art so strong, ye clouds that sail in heav'n a-long,
3 Thou flow-ing wa-ter, pure and clear, make mu-sic for thy God to hear,
4 Dear moth-er earth, who day by day, un-fold-est bless-ings on our way,
5 And ev-'ry-one, with ten-der heart, for-giv-ing oth-ers, take your part,
6 And thou, most kind and gen-tle death, wait-ing to hush our fi-nal breath,
7 Let all things their Cre-a-tor bless, and wor-ship God in hum-ble-ness,

al-le-lu-ia, al-le-lu-ia!

1 Thou burn-ing sun with gold-en beam, thou sil-ver moon with soft-er gleam,
2 Thou ris-ing morn in praise re-joice, ye lights of eve-ning find a voice,
3 Thou fire so mas-ter-ful and bright, that giv-est all both warmth and light,
4 The flow'rs and fruits that in thee grow, let them God's glo-ry al-so show,
5 Ye who long pain and sor-row bear, sing praise and cast on God your care,
6 Thou lead-est home the child of God, as Christ be-fore that way hath trod,
7 To God all thanks and praise be-long! Join in the ev-er-last-ing song:

O sing ye, O sing ye, al-le-lu-ia, al-le-lu-ia, al-le-lu-ia!

*Or, "All creatures of our God and King, / lift up your voice and with us sing"